Daily reports · 3 November 2026

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Syria Narrative Tracker · as of the last update, 3 November 2026, 19:34 UTC

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1. The day at a glance

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Divided Coverage this period centers on the foiled Homs refinery plot blamed on a Hezbollah-linked cell, continued Israeli incursions in Quneitra and Damascus countryside, the new 8am-4pm work hours decree, Kurdish education protests over the Kobani-Aleppo university merger, and lingering Suwayda sectarian tensions. Official and independent outlets lean toward reassurance and diplomatic/economic progress (IMF return, agricultural compensation, Spain/China partnerships), while public voices show more skepticism, mockery of media figures, anger over landmine deaths, and divided views on Druze, Kurdish and sectarian issues. President al-Sharaa's Old Damascus tour drew an outpouring of devotional public comments, contrasting with sharper public criticism elsewhere.

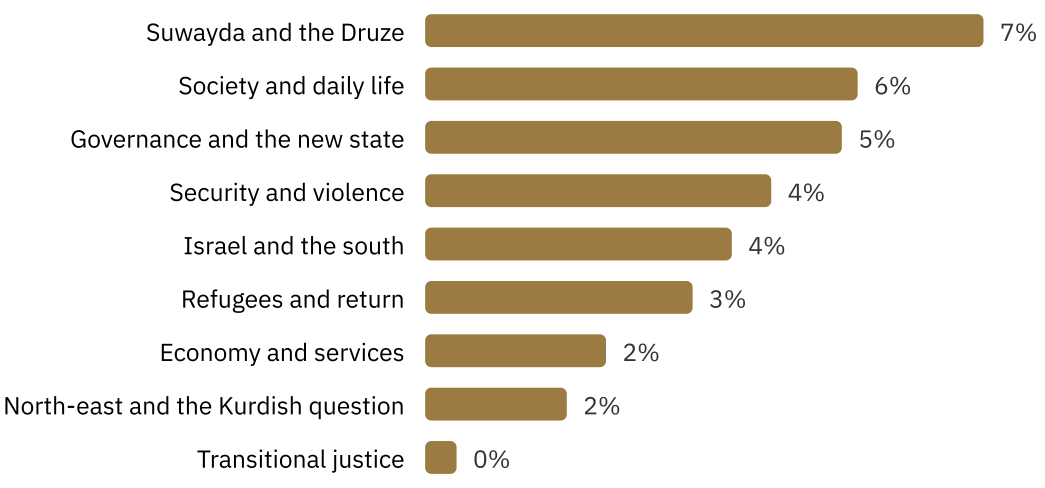
2. What people said

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The day in numbers

Mostly neutral	Mostly neutral	14	3,058	4
People's tone	Outlets' tone	stories followed	post analyses	updates

Share of discussion by theme



The day's stories

1. **Al-Ittihad Aleppo's draw with Qamishli Sport fuels coaching and fan backlash** Society and daily life · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 12% of the discussion
   Ahli Aleppo's draw against Qamishli Sport in the Syrian league, reportedly affected by a car accident involving Qamishli players, triggered widespread fan anger at coach Tita Valerio and calls for former coach Ahmad Hawash's return. Commenters also criticized refereeing and praised Homs clubs' strong form this season.

2. **Ongoing tensions over Suwayda clashes and sectarian framing in media** Suwayda and the Druze · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 8% of the discussion
   Public debate continued over Suwayda, with YouTube commenters divided over the role of Druze leader Hikmat al-Hajri and the Syrian army, some praising a program host's confrontation with a guest, others accusing media of sectarian bias. Al-Watan contrasted Hasakah and Suwayda as sites of instability tools.

3. **President al-Sharaa's tour of Old Damascus draws outpouring of public devotion** Governance and the new state · People: strongly positive · Outlets: leaning positive · 7% of the discussion
   President Ahmad al-Sharaa visited a fabric shop during a tour of Old Damascus, an area he grew up in, generating a large wave of YouTube comments praising his humility and asking God to protect him. The visit was covered by state and independent outlets as a symbolic homecoming gesture.

4. **Anger over new 8am-4pm work hours decree** Governance and the new state · People: strongly negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 7% of the discussion
   The Syrian presidency issued a decree setting official daily working hours for administrative state bodies from 8am to 4pm starting December 1, 2026. Outlets reported the decision as administrative reform, but many public commenters say it increases hours without raising already-low wages. Economic-sector bodies are exempted and can set their own schedules.

5. **Security forces say they foiled Hezbollah-linked plot against Homs refinery** Security and violence · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 6% of the discussion
   Syria's Internal Security Forces and intelligence said Tuesday they foiled a plot to bomb the Homs oil refinery, arresting a cell they linked to Hezbollah and seizing explosives. Hezbollah denied any presence or involvement in Syria. Economists warned any refinery disruption could raise fuel import costs and prices.

6. **Lebanese delegation visits Damascus on refugee returns, borders and bilateral ties** Refugees and return · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 5% of the discussion
   A Lebanese ministerial delegation led by Deputy PM Tarek Mitri met Syrian FM Asaad al-Shaibani in Damascus to discuss Syrian refugee returns, border security, and related legal and educational issues. Lebanese President Joseph Aoun separately said Lebanon can no longer absorb more Syrian refugees and called on the international community to redirect aid to Syria.

7. **Israeli incursions, demolitions and detentions continue across Quneitra and rural Damascus** Israel and the south · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 5% of the discussion
   Israeli forces conducted multiple incursions, demolitions and artillery strikes across Quneitra and western rural Damascus this week, including blowing up abandoned military buildings near Darbal and shelling farmland near Saida al-Hanout. Levant24 reported nearly 400 Israeli violations in southern Syria in October. Locals and olive farmers were affected.

8. **Kobani-Aleppo university merger and Kurdish-language curbs spark protests** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 3% of the discussion
   Kurdish students in Hasakah and Rojava University protested the Education Ministry's limit on Kurdish-language classes to three weekly periods and the planned merger of Kobani University with Aleppo University. The PYD rejected the policy; Kobani University formed a joint committee with Aleppo to process the merger.

9. **Public anger over prolonged electricity cuts in Aleppo** Economy and services · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 2% of the discussion
   A segment reporting 19 hours without power in Aleppo sparked angry public comments blaming both the former regime and the current authorities, with some mocking suggestions to install solar panels instead and others defending the cuts as the 'price of freedom.' Separately, Ikhbariya reported complaints over rising rationing hours in Maskaneh due to maintenance work.

10. **Foreign Ministry appoints Muzna al-Atrash as Druze peace adviser** Governance and the new state · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    Syria's Foreign Minister Asaad al-Shaibani appointed media personality Muzna al-Atrash as adviser for peace affairs, a role outlets say remains undefined. Coverage framed it as outreach toward the Druze community following Suwayda tensions.

11. **Landmine and war remnant blasts continue killing children across Syria** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning negative · 1% of the discussion
    A boy died in Daraa and a girl died in southern Idlib this week from landmine and unexploded ordnance blasts, among several similar incidents reported by independent and Kurdish outlets. Mine-clearance teams in Ras al-Ain cleared over 300 mines but risks remain widespread.

12. **Calm returns to Hama's Sawaiq neighborhood after armed clash between two families** Security and violence · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    Calm returned to Hama's Sawaiq neighborhood after an armed clash between two families led to several arrests, according to Syria TV and Enab Baladi. The incident briefly disrupted the area before security forces intervened.

13. **New 8am-4pm official work hours decree draws public unease** Governance and the new state · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    The Presidency's General Secretariat announced new official work hours from 8am to 4pm starting next month for administrative public bodies. State media framed it as modernization; Al Jazeera reported mixed public reactions. Social media comments questioned whether longer hours mean better pay or just more work.

14. **Transitional justice court continues proceedings on former security officials** Transitional justice · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    Syria's National Commission for Transitional Justice announced the arrest of former regime Major General Muhammad Hassan al-Sharif over suspected war crimes. The Fourth Criminal Court specialized in transitional justice held sessions in Damascus. A separate recovery center for victims of rights violations was also highlighted.

3. Sources and method

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